ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 1

Chapter 15: **That Little Square Box** | Class 8 English_Gulmohar | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(c)** so the reader can share his fears and laugh at them later	A nervous everyman creates both suspense and humour.
2	**(b)** readers sense a harmless explanation while the narrator fears death	Readers may suspect the truth before he does.
3	**(b)** it exposes his panic to everyone on deck	He looks foolish.
4	**(c)** the men's pleased smiles when the clicking is heard	Their calm contentment contradicts the narrator's fears.
5	**(c)** Do not draw conclusions from partial evidence.	He misjudges by acting on guesswork.
6	**(c)** he was truly afraid for lives	Relief matches earlier fear.
7	**(b)** ambiguity	It can be read innocently or as an explosion.
8	**(b)** scenes in thrillers where a bomb is about to explode	It borrows thriller conventions for comedy.
9	**(b)** it makes his fear and his duty to speak seem more urgent	Imagining many lives at stake raises the pressure.
10	**(a)** more afraid of ridicule than of danger	Social fear holds him back.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	The phrase can mean releasing pigeons (1) or setting off a bomb, as the narrator assumes (1).	1+1
12	It stops him from warning the captain (1), forcing him to act alone and make a scene (1).	1+1
13	Contrast of terror and a harmless pigeon race (1). The men think him mad (1).	1+1
14	In the first person we share the narrator's fears (1) and later see how misleading they were (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	Last-minute boarding, box, grains, clicking (1). Each clue fits the narrator's fear (1). Readers are led to the same wrong conclusion (1).	1+1+1
16	Narrator's terror vs. men's calm (1). Expected bomb vs. harmless pigeons (1). Tense mood vs. humorous ending (1).	1+1+1
17	The box really holds a danger (1). The narrator is a hero (1). The mood becomes grave instead of comic (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Suspense builds as ten o'clock nears (1). Surprise comes when pigeons emerge (1). Both together create the twist (1).	1+1+1
18	The narrator trusts only his fears (1). He does not ask the men (1). Open questions could have solved the problem (1).	1+1+1
	OR: The narrator jumps from the lifeboat (1). He acts without checking (1). The result is embarrassment (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Narrator lacks information (1). Imagination fills the gap (1). Every clue seems threatening (1). Facts at the end dissolve fear (1). Lesson: ask and verify (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Greeting and opening (1). The narrator's example (1). Costs of panic (1). Steps: verify, ask, then act (1). Closing (1).	2+2+1
20	Plot and suspense (1). Characterisation (1). Dramatic wording and irony (1). The surprise ending (1). Message (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Date and ship (1). Report of a passenger leaping from a lifeboat (1). The pigeon race (1). Action taken (1). Remarks on prejudice and safety (1).	2+2+1

Evaluator's note: Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.

MASTERMIND

ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 2

Chapter 15: **That Little Square Box** | Class 8 English_Gulmohar | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(a)** captains' prejudice against such sports aboard ships	It gives the men a reason to hide it.
2	**(a)** gently laughs at needless panic	The humour is mild and good-natured.
3	**(d)** the clock deadline of ten o'clock	A fixed time creates countdown tension.
4	**(b)** the ship's name	The ship's name is not part of the puzzle.
5	**(c)** light-hearted	The twist is humorous.
6	**(a)** he cares for his own safety while still unwilling to speak	He prefers hiding to speaking.
7	**(b)** the mystery would vanish	He knows the truth throughout.
8	**(c)** alertness	Alertness might save lives, but he needed evidence.
9	**(b)** no one is hurt and the fear was unfounded	Harmless truth turns fear into comedy.
10	**(c)** The narrator said that he would tell the captain.	Shall -> would; I -> he.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	Quietly asked the men or informed the captain (1). This would have cleared the mystery without panic (1).	1+1
12	A suitable sentence (1). Links to the narrator's reading of the men's behaviour (1).	1+1
13	It suggests a weapon (1) and heightens the narrator's alarm (1).	1+1
14	Imagination turns small clues into big dangers (1). Fear grows without facts (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	We sometimes hesitate to report concerns (1). We fear mistakes or ridicule (1). Balance of caution and evidence is needed (1).	1+1+1
16	Hiding protects him (1). But it does not help others (1). Raising a calm alarm would have been better (1).	1+1+1
17	Nervous at boarding (1). Terrified in the lifeboat (1). Shocked, embarrassed, relieved at the end (1).	1+1+1
	OR: He believes he is saving lives (1). He panics without facts (1). The humour makes him comic, but his concern is sincere (1).	1+1+1
18	When he heard the clicking, he feared a bomb (1). 'When' introduces a subordinate clause (1). Cause and effect are clear (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Pigeons need feeding and care, hence grains (1). The clicking is from the birds (1). Secrecy protects the race (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Date and setting (1). Recall of the fears (1). The shock of the truth (1). Embarrassment and relief (1). A resolve to be careful (1).	2+2+1
	OR: We see events through his fears (1). His exaggerated thoughts amuse us (1). The truth contrasts sharply (1). He mocks himself implicitly (1). The effect is warm humour (1).	2+2+1
20	Narrator's apology (1). Men's good humour (1). Explanation of the race (1). Captain's attitude (1). Narrator's resolution (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Flannigan's pride in the winning pigeon (1). Laughter at the narrator (1). The secret race (1). Concern for the narrator (1). Closing remarks (1).	2+2+1

Evaluator's note: Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.

THE MASTERMIND COACHING CLASSES

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ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 3

Chapter 15: **That Little Square Box** | Class 8 English_Gulmohar | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(a)** Secretive behaviour -> narrator's suspicion	Secrecy fed his suspicion.
2	**(d)** the mystery cleared quietly	He could have learnt about the pigeons.
3	**(c)** He had hidden before the clock struck ten.	Past perfect = had + past participle.
4	**(c)** A Needless Panic at Sea	The story is about unfounded fear.
5	**(a)** first person	The narrator tells his own experience.
6	**(b)** open	Open = not hiding things.
7	**(d)** Verify information before sharing alarming news	Applies to rumours and fake news.
8	**(b)** the box looked like a pistol case	Comparisons make the box sinister.
9	**(d)** uncommunicative	They gave no information.
10	**(b)** jumping to conclusions	He assumed the worst with little proof.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	Isolation at sea makes a danger feel inescapable (1). It also explains the captain's authority and prejudice (1).	1+1
12	It gives a countdown (1) that builds tension up to the climax (1).	1+1
13	The narrator thought that he would jump out (1). Will -> would and pronoun changed (1).	1+1
14	Fear without evidence leads to panic (1). Verifying facts prevents embarrassment (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	He is the authority the narrator fears to approach (1). His prejudice explains the secrecy (1). His absence keeps the focus on the narrator (1).	1+1+1
16	He sees a bomb (1). It holds racing pigeons (1). The gap between belief and truth drives the humour (1).	1+1+1
17	It makes the lesson easy to remember (1). It avoids blaming the narrator harshly (1). Readers learn through laughter (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Time is measured in seconds (1). The narrator's thoughts of death add drama (1). The scene mirrors thrillers, making the twist funnier (1).	1+1+1
18	Captains' prejudice forces secrecy (1). Secrecy fuels suspicion (1). Open understanding would have avoided the scare (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Beginning: voyage and the box (1). Middle: suspicion, countdown (1). End: twist and pigeons fly (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Pistol case look (1). Secret talk (1). Whitish grains (1). Clicking (1). All fit a false story, showing how easily we misjudge (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Ask when in doubt (1). Do not assume (1). Secrecy breeds suspicion (1). Openness avoids panic (1). Courage to speak honestly (1).	2+2+1
20	In the story fear causes false alarm (1). In the chapter fear of wildlife harms species (1). Both show lack of understanding (1). Knowledge removes fear (1). Both teach us to seek facts (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Setting and cast (1). Narrator's fear (1). Men's secretive talk (1). Jump and shout (1). Pigeons and laughter (1).	2+2+1

Evaluator's note: Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.